

STORY

During the early 2020s, a disease called the “Dust Devil Plague” started spreading across earth. The plague made earth unfit for habitation and the prospect of other planets became a priority. An organisation called Mandate launched several missions to a new planet (sounds a lot like Interstellar so far doesn't it?).

200 years have passed since the incident and you don the role of Joule Adams on the planet of Far Eden. The planet is in desolation and very reminiscent of Jakku where we find Rey in Star Wars: The Force Awakens, minus the living beings of course. During the course of the 200 years, robots called corebots were supposed to make the planet habitable for people. These robots became corrupt and it is your job to figure out what went wrong.

I haven't encountered a similar bug since then. The game also takes really long to load which gets annoying most of the times. Coming to the core gameplay, it's a third-person shooter with platforming and puzzle elements thrown into the mix.

Kicking things off with the gunplay, it starts out quite easy with auto-aim enabled and for the first hour the game is very easy. But later you get different color-coded enemies that need to be hit with the particular colour guns and this mixes up the gameplay quite well. The colour of your ammunition can be changed with the D-pad and the control mechanism takes some getting used too.

Moving on, you have three corebot companions that accompany you throughout the game. Sadly, all three are not with you all the time and each

GRAPHICS

The graphics of the game are above average with few stutters. This is one of the first Xbox Play Anywhere games and the graphics clearly look richer on the PC. It looks like a low graphical port was made for the Xbox One. Having said that, the game doesn't look bad. In fact, if you aren't finicky about attention to detail, then the game will look okay to you.

SOUND

The voice acting in the game is good but the sounds of Joule's weapons is slightly childish. For some reason when Joule Adams' dad is narrating the backstory in the game, I am consistently reminded of the “Father to Son” Batman: Arkham Knight Announce Trailer. The background score on the other hand is good and



A good thing about the story is that it doesn't tell you all this in the beginning. You discover a lot of the backstory from audio logs left by Joule's dad and it's an interesting way to deliver the story. The story of the game isn't groundbreaking but it is interesting.

GAMEPLAY

Let's get the worst out of the way. When I started playing the game it was buggy and plagued with random crashes. There were times when I had completed an objective and the marker on the map still showed me the same objective as the one to be pursued and this happened twice. The game however received an update and

of them have abilities that are required during various missions of the game. This leads to a lot of backtracking which after a point can get quite annoying. You have the ability to upgrade the corebots' combat strength, aesthetics and more. The upgrade tree is quite vast and addictive for those that get drawn into it.

Moving on, the game has a bunch of puzzles to solve and few head-scratching ones tend to make you look stupid at the end.

Overall the gameplay of ReCore is fun but has its shortfalls and the shooting can get very repetitive after some time. It has its moments where you will have fun but overall the gameplay fails to make a lasting impression.

hits the right high notes during tense sequences, while it goes absolutely silent during exploration.

VERDICT

ReCore is an above average experience at best. If you are one that enjoys games like Ratchet & Clank then you will have fun with this experience. The overall graphics and frame rate of the game on the Xbox One could have been better. The lifespan of the game feels stretched. With all the backtracking, you can complete the game in 10 hours but it looks like the backtracking was there so the game doesn't end in under eight hours. After the first play through, there is little reason to revisit this experience once it has ended. *